

GroupTrack

Google Play Store Setup Guide

Created April 5, 2026 — Keep for Reference

1. Your Release Keystore — CRITICAL

The keystore is your permanent app signing identity. Google Play ties your app to this key FOREVER. If you lose it, you can never update the app on Google Play.

Item	Value
Keystore file	grouptrack-release-key.jks
Alias	grouptrack
Created	April 5, 2026
Valid for	10,000 days (~27 years)
Key algorithm	RSA 2048-bit

Keystore Backup Locations — All 4 Must Be Maintained:

#	Location	Path
1	Local (primary)	C:/Users/kixaz/grouptrack-release-key.jks
2	Google Drive	/GroupTrack Application Keys/grouptrack-release-key.jks
3	iCloud Drive	/GroupTrack Application Keys/grouptrack-release-key.jks
4	Desktop	/GroupTrack Application Keys/grouptrack-release-key.jks

keystore.properties lives at ~/Meshtastic-Android/keystore.properties and is in .gitignore — NEVER commit to git repository.

2. Google Play Developer Account Setup

One-time \$25 fee. Account approval takes 2-3 days. Start this TODAY so the account is ready when the first Play Store release is ready (V2.4.1 — Sunday April 12).

Sign up at:

<https://play.google.com/console>

Requirement	Detail
Google account	Same account used for Google Sign-In in GroupTrack

Registration fee	\$25 USD — one-time, non-refundable
Developer name	GroupTrack (or your legal name)
Email address	Developer contact — visible to users
Privacy policy URL	https://grouptrack.org/privacy — already live
Support URL	https://grouptrack.org or info@grouptrack.org
Phone verification	Required during signup
Approval time	2-3 business days typically

Use your real name and real address. Google rejects accounts that look incomplete or fake.

3. Google Play Release Tracks

All tracks use the same signed APK from the same keystore. Promote builds up the track ladder.

Track	Testers	Review	Use For
Internal Testing	Up to 100	Instant — no review	V2.4.1 first Play upload — current testers
Closed Beta (Alpha)	Invite only	Minimal review	Wider tester group before production
Open Beta	Anyone	Standard review	Pre-production public testing
Production	Everyone	Full review	General release — V3.0+

4. GroupTrack Release Plan

Date	Version	Distribution	Notes
April 5	V2.4 Production	Direct APK to testers	Production package. RECALC fix. Cover letter.
April 12	V2.4.1	Play Store Internal Testing	Radio 2.7 fix. First Play Store upload.
April 19	V2.4.2	Play Store Internal/Beta	Tester issues. Map improvements.
April 26	V2.4.3	Play Store Beta	Stabilization or V3.0 preview.
May+	V3.0	Play Store Production	Full platform launch.

Testers migrate from direct APK to Play Store at V2.4.1. Play Store handles automatic updates from that point forward.

5. App Listing Requirements for Play Store

Item	Status	Detail
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App name	Ready	GroupTrack
Short description	Needed	30 chars max — off-grid group tracking for riders
Full description	Needed	4000 chars — features, use cases, requirements
Screenshots	Needed	Min 2 phone screenshots. Tablet optional.
Feature graphic	Needed	1024x500px banner image
App icon	Ready	Sky blue #4AB8E8 adaptive icon — already in build
Privacy policy URL	Ready	https://grouptrack.org/privacy
Content rating	Needed	Complete questionnaire — expected Everyone
Target audience	Needed	18+ recommended (outdoor activities)
Category	Needed	Travel & Local or Sports